

Illustration by GAURAV SARJERAO

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RAHUL BHATIA, 67

CEO, INTERGLOBE ENTERPRISES

THE HIGH FLYER

BECAUSE IndiGo continues to be the dominant player in domestic air travel. In March this year, the low-cost airline had a passenger share of 56.8 per cent with a total of 7.3 mn travellers. IndiGo runs 1,700-odd flights daily to 103 destinations, 26 of them on foreign shores. The budget carrier has a fleet strength of 300 aircraft, achieving the milestone in January 2023

BECAUSE IndiGo is bound to gain most with the airline Go First going bust and the 20-22 per cent quarter-on-quarter expansion of air passenger traffic in the country

BECAUSE The hands-on but discreet Bhatia may soon add 20-odd wide-body aircraft to IndiGo's fleet, suggesting that like Air India, Vistara, it may be looking at more mid-haul destinations to expand its reach. IndiGo is also in talks with Airbus and Boeing to buy 500 new aircraft

DIGITAL BLIP **In the mid-'80s, young Rahul Bhatia, sensing that India was opening up to the digital world, clinched a deal with Canada-based Northern Telecom (Nortel) to make digital telecom exchanges, but later lost out to state-owned C-DoT**

BECAUSE IndiGo co-founders Rahul Bhatia and Rakesh Gangwal, with individual net worth of more than $3 billion (Rs 24,900 crore), are the wealthiest 'aviation billionaires' in the world, according to the Hurun Global Rich list